



Alphabet plans high-tech city

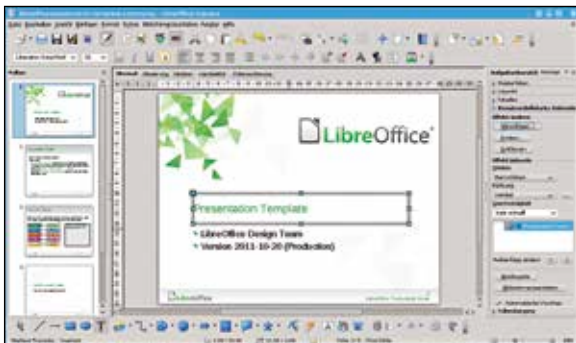
Alphabet's side labs are planning to build a full high-tech city which can house 'hundreds of thousands'. <http://dgit.in/AlphaHTCIt>



Apple helps the planet

Apple has planned to donate the funds it makes from 27 popular apps in the App Store to the World Wildlife Fund (WWF). <http://dgit.in/APsave>

Smart SoHo



LibreOffice is actually too good to be free

the ISO/IEC standard OpenDocument Format (ODF) as its own format to save all of its applications, along with a number of file formats from other popular suites that you can import from and export to.

If you look for a comparison between LibreOffice and Microsoft Office, you might actually get more than what you signed up for. For starters, LibreOffice 5.1 is available for Windows, Mac OS X, Linux, FreeBSD, NetBSD and OpenBSD, all with the same codebase, whereas MS Office is available for Windows and Mac OS X, that too with different codebases that lead to compatibility issues, along with factors like the OS X MS Office version not having MS Access. LibreOffice also comes in a portable format that can be directly used from a pendrive, which might be very useful in a small office scenario. There is also very strong integration of all Office components, with files of one application opening smoothly from files of another application and a centralized StartCenter. You will also get a centralized access page for any extensions that you may want to install. It is really one of the best alternates to a more common suite. And the best part – it's all for free.



GIMP is good enough for most needs

Photo Editing - GIMP

This one needs no introduction. GIMP has been quite well known as a free Photoshop alternative for a while, and its current version is a highly capable application with full scale photo editing and digital painting capabilities. It is completely open source and anyone can change its source code

and redistribute the changes. That is one of the reasons why there is a very rich ecosystem of plugins and addons available for GIMP that give it a host of capabilities. The GIMP Plugin registry contains plugins created by users worldwide.

While there are many use cases in which Photoshop is quite irreplaceable, it is also true that GIMP is a very useful and powerful alternative. For example, if you're on a tight budget and don't really need an extremely powerful photo editing tool at your disposal all the time, then GIMP is the best option you can take. It is definitely more powerful than the standard photo-editing options you get on apps like Instagram and Google Photos, and with the correct combination of extensions, you can do wonders with this popular Open Source application. The sweet bit - GIMP supports PSD out of the box, so you don't worry about your colleague sending you that WIP file.

Special Note - If you are on Linux, close your eyes and get GIMP.

Digital Illustration - Inkscape

One of the recurring names when it comes to free or low cost alternatives to Adobe Illustrator is Inkscape. With its native format being Scalable Vector Graphics (SVG), it is truly powerful in vector designing, with support for shape building,

gradient mesh and more. In a showdown with Illustrator, one of the first pain points that shows up obviously is the price, with an Adobe Illustrator license going for ₹12,000/year, compared to Inkscape being completely free. On the basis of features, it is a harder call to make because both have features that the other lacks. For example, Illustrator supports Gradient mesh and multiple strokes and fills for one object, whereas Inkscape supports editing the SVG source directly as well as treating shapes as objects.

Even when it comes to the user interface and user support available, Inkscape opts for simplicity and readability, which is often perceived by power users as a lack of actual capabilities. Keep in mind that both Inkscape and Illustrator are targeted



Still want to pay for Illustrator?

towards SVG development, which is mainly meant for web-usage, and not the heavier raster-graphics. In case you do want to try out Inkscape, here are a few interesting tutorials to get you started : <http://dgit.in/InksTut>

Special Note: Some of you might be wondering why we didn't put Coreldraw up here. Well, if you are shedding some features for a lower price, why not go all the way?

Desktop Publishing - Scribus

As an alternative to Adobe's desktop publishing software Indesign, Scribus is an open source tool filled with useful tools for all the publishing purposed that you might need it for – typesetting, print design, interactive PDF creation, layout design and more. The Scribus user